

Title: How far can wave management and level up timers go in terms of complexity and also rank?

Score:

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Bit of a weird question, but I've only really started playing this season properly and have finally understood the basics of wave management and level up timers. Genuinely has made a massive impact to my laning. But I am bronze, and I think part of why it's working so well is because of that, so I'm wondering what happens for the higher elos where both people understand them well, does it just get more complex in terms of wave management or just matchup specifics? And what elo do the sort of the basics fall off?

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 10]

I see challenger streamers apply these basics in every game they play. It never goes away. They plan multiple waves in advance and know exactly when they will level up, leveraging these small advantages into favorable trades, kills, better resets, opportunities to proxy, etc.

[Comment 2 | Score: 3]

im a master rank tahm kench one trick (NA). the way i see the game currently is like this: champion mastery>fundamentals>niche knowledge

fundamentals are extremely important, but you need champion mastery to know what your role is in the game and how to apply those fundamental concepts. after mastering core concepts, youre trying to stack little pieces of niche knowledge and creative plays to get just a tiny edge on the best players.

unfortunately, i think 2025's wave management (and predictability) is really watered down (because of patch 25.S1.1 minion update), and its hard for me to differentiate between high and low elo off wave management alone.

it matters of course, and it will help you climb, but its just not the same as before. most of the time youll just be pushing or getting pushed in on repeat, whereas before there was a lot of creativity and option (slow push into dive or recall, freeze, etc.) basically the game is more team oriented than ever right now i think.

interested to hear other opinions as always though. ive been playing tk bot lately, and it feels like wave management exists more in bot than top, because occasionally you have a support that can make holding waves back worth it (whereas in top it almost never feels worth it, because youll take a lot of damage from minions + a competent enemy, just for it to crash shortly after anyways)

[Comment 3 | Score: 2]

Those basics never fall off, they are part of the laning fundamentals and you'll need to be working on them and improving them basically indefinitely.

Being able to utilize them to punish is especially rewarding when opponents don't respect it which most Bronze/Silver players aren't going to "lucky level up!" yeah ok buddy.

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

Wave management and level up timers scale indefinitely. Your knowledge of wave management and level up timers get better, and you go up in rank. Now your opponents also have a good grasp on wave management and level up timers. Both people will have an idea of how the matchup plays out in their head. Now it becomes a war of trying to get the wave to be in the favorable position for

their side of the matchup.

Now the war over wave management and level up timers come down to much smaller things. The person who is .5 secs faster at reading and deciphering a wave state, is able to leverage that and start manipulating the wave first. It comes down to the person who is in lane 1 sec earlier than their opponent, so they get 1 extra autoattack on the wave, so it pushes faster and they hit level 2 first.

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

In higher elo your window to for things like plays on the map or trading get smaller. You also get punished a lot more for mistakes. The basics are applicable in every rank. The higher you go the more consistent it is though.